STEPS FOR MANAGERS TO ADDRESS WORKPLACE HARASSMENT

1 Respond Promptly

If approached with a harassment complaint or situation, schedule a meeting in a private location.

Review relevant:
- Information.
- Policies.
- Procedures.

Listen objectively.

Advise on:
- Confidentiality.
- Responsibility.
- Rights.

Address sensitivity of situation during inquiry.

2 Obtain Information

Define:
- Issue.
- Nature.
- Scope.

Consider:
- Safety issues.
- Reporting structure.

Communicate EAP and EEO options.

Inform and confer with Manager, HR, local district or area office (for HQ and HQ field units, next-higher-level manager).

Discuss remedies.

If further inquiry is warranted, proceed to IMIP.

3 Begin IMIP

Gather Initial Management Inquiry Process (IMIP) forms.

Arrange separate interviews for all parties involved.

Advise on IMIP process.

Gather detailed data.

Request that a written statement be prepared.

Establish timelines for follow-up.

If, in the course of this IMIP, you believe that the nature and scope of the complaint warrant outside investigation or that resolution is not feasible, you must refer complaint to Manager, HR, local district or area office (for HQ and HQ field units, next-higher-level manager).

4 Evaluate Information

Assess credibility of statements

Gather missing data

Identify the type of harassment discussed

Evaluate employment status change

Inform and confer with Manager, HR, local district or area office (for HQ and HQ field units, next-higher-level manager).

Determine corrective action

If criminal action has occurred, notify Postal Inspection Service and local law enforcement.

Report to the OIG any use of electronic devices, computer, or internet to transmit harassing communications.

5 Plan of Action

Consult about remedies or discipline with Manager, HR, and Labor Relations (for HQ and HQ field units, next-higher-level manager).

Ensure that the investigation was conducted properly

Deliver the determination separately to harasser and harassee.

Emphasize:
- Retaliation is illegal.
- Report future incidents.

Resolve issues.

Document action taken.

6 Follow Up

Send IMIP documents to Manager, HR, local district or area (for HQ and HQ field units, next-higher-level manager).

Maintain confidentiality.

Convey Postal Service's Zero Tolerance Harassment Policy in:
- Remedial training.
- Stand-up talks.
- Staff meetings.

Educate yourself and personnel on up-to-date policy.

Enforce Postal Service policy.

Follow up and monitor the workplace.

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